

HS 606: Political Philosophy

Course Code	HS 606
Course Name	Political Philosophy
L-T-P-C	4-0-0-4
Prerequisites	For research scholars; familiarity with history of Western thought and Teachers Consent
Intended for	PG
Distribution	Elective
Approval	8th Senate (Oct 2015)

Course Contents

The course seeks to examine the following aspects: the human sense of justice; the quest for and the pursuit of the Good Life; the theoretical study of political life constituting political theory; political philosophy proceeding from the Classics to pose the problems of the unexamined life and to investigate political life as it ought to be; the search for the right order of public life, the constraints it encounters and the resources it seeks in its bid to tame power and compound the ruler and the ruled into the true frame of a commonweal.

Samplings from some of the following representative texts seek to familiarize the scholar with the long tradition of politico-philosophic writing:

1. Plato: **Republic**, Book II 2. Aristotle: **Nicomachean Ethics**, Book III; **Politics**, Book II 3. Xenophon: **Cyropaedia** 4. St Augustine: **City of God**, Part II, Books xi to xiv; 5. Machiavelli: **Discorsi**, Book I, Chs. 1-20 6. Shakespeare: **The Tempest** 7. Montesquieu: **The Spirit of the Laws**, Book 17 8. Thomas Hobbes: **Leviathan**, Part I; 9. Rousseau: **mile**, or **On Education**; 10. Immanuel Kant: **Idea for a Universal History from a Cosmopolitan Point of View**; 11. Edmund Burke: **Reflections on the Revolution in France**; 12. Karl Marx: **Preface to the Critique of Political Economy**; 13. John Stuart Mill: **Utilitarianism**; 14. Thoreau: **On Civil Disobedience**; 15. Gandhi: **Satyagraha**; 16. Carl Mitcham: **Technology and the Character of the Good Life**.

Readings

1. Cassirer, Ernst, *The Myth of the State*. New Haven/New York (Yale U.P.) 1946.
2. Germino, Dante, *Machiavelli to Marx*. Modern Western Political Thought. Chicago 1979.
3. White, Michael J., *Political Philosophy. An Historical Introduction*. Oxford 2003.

References

1. Cohen, Martin, *Political Philosophy. From Plato to Mao*. London 2001.
2. Cushman, Robert E., *Therapeia. Platos Conception of Philosophy*. North Carolina 1958.
3. Goodin, Robert E./Pettit, Philip (Ed.), *Contemporary Political Philosophy. An Anthology*. Oxford 1997.
4. Kailitz, Steffen, *Schlsselwerke der Politikwissenschaft*. Wiesbaden 2007.
5. Kymlicka, Will, *Justice in Political Philosophy*, 2 Volumes. Aldershot 1992.
6. Matravers, Derek/Pike, John, (Ed.), *Debates in Contemporary Political Philosophy. An Anthology*. London 2003.
7. Meier, Heinrich, *Warum Politische Philosophie?* Stuttgart 2000.
8. Oakeshott, Michael, *Rationalism in Politics*. LSE Inaugural Lecture. London 1962. (any edition).
9. Rawls, John, *Lectures on the History of Political Philosophy*. Harvard 2008.
10. Strauss, Leo, *What is Political Philosophy?* New York 1973.
11. Strauss, Leo/Cropsey, Joseph, *History of Political Philosophy*. Chicago 1987.
12. Voegelin, Eric, *the New Science of Politics*. Chicago 1952.